

RESPIRATORY PROTECTION

Control airborne hazards at source and, when a respirator is required, verify the correct device and cartridge, medical clearance, fit testing and user seal check.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Control airborne hazards at source and, when a respirator is required, verify the correct device and cartridge, medical clearance, fit testing and user seal check.

KEY HAZARDS

 DUST	 FUME	 VAPOUR	 GAS
 OXYGEN DEFICIENCY	 WRONG CARTRIDGE	 POOR FIT	 FACIAL HAIR

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

100% Medical clearance and task match	Annual Fit test for tight-fitting respirators	Every use User seal check
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REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1910.134 requires a written program integrating hazard evaluation, medical evaluation, fit testing, training and maintenance.

OSHA 1910.134(c)

WRITTEN PROGRAM

Document task-specific selection, use, maintenance and program-administrator responsibilities.

OSHA 1910.134(e)

MEDICAL EVALUATION

Confirm medical ability to wear the respirator before fit testing or use.

OSHA 1910.134(f)

FIT TESTING

Fit test the same make, model, style and size before initial use and at least annually.

OSHA 1910.134(k)

TRAINING

Train limitations, donning, doffing, seal checks, signs of failure and maintenance in practice.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Exposure assessment / monitoring | ☐ Written respiratory program |
| ☐ Medical-clearance record | ☐ Fit-test record |
| ☐ Cartridge-change schedule | ☐ Training and maintenance record |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What is the contaminant and concentration?
- Why is this cartridge suitable?
- How is the seal check performed?

FIT, CARTRIDGE AND SEAL CHECK



Medical clearance - Fit test - Correct cartridge - Clean-shaven seal - Seal check

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. ELIMINATE THE SOURCE

Choose a less hazardous material or method; never assume exposure without assessment.

2. VENTILATE AND ISOLATE

Use local exhaust and enclosure; select equipment for contaminant type and concentration.

3. SELECT THE CORRECT RESPIRATOR

Verify medical clearance and fit test; keep facial hair out of the sealing surface.

4. FIT, CHECK AND MAINTAIN

Perform a seal check every use; follow cartridge change, cleaning and dry-storage schedules.

CRITICAL WARNING



Never use an air-purifying respirator in an unknown, oxygen-deficient or IDLH atmosphere. Stop and plan an appropriate supplied-air system.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Exposure assessed | ☐ Source control installed |
| ☐ Respirator task-suitable | ☐ Medical clearance current |
| ☐ Fit test current | ☐ Facial hair clear |
| ☐ Cartridge correct / current | ☐ Seal check passed |
| ☐ Clean storage ready | |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
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9			
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11			
12			